

2015 年 12 月大学英语四级考试真题（第 1 套）

Part I

Writing

(30minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay commenting on the saying “*Learning is a daily experience and a lifetime mission.*” You can cite examples to illustrate the importance of lifelong learning. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

Part II

Listening Comprehension

(25 minutes)

2016 年四六级听力改革，本套试题中的听力题目已按照最新题型进行优化，与现在所考题型完全一致，可放心使用。

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. A) An abnormal winter snow storm.
B) The first warm front from Europe.
C) The frequent choking smog.
D) The unusual warm winter.
2. A) From Saturday afternoon.
B) From this Friday.
C) In the next spring.
D) During the Christmas holiday.

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

3. A) The project of free digital off-line resources in Nigeria.
B) The project of free video lessons in Nigeria.
C) The digital library in Ahmadu Bello University.
D) The non-profit organizations in Ahmadu Bello University.
4. A) Multimedia work.
B) Digital documents.
C) Informative websites.
D) Computer software.

Questions 5 to 7 are based on the news report you have just heard.

5. A) It hit another car.
B) It was overspeed.
C) It hit a driving bus in the road.
D) It hit a Lexus SUV.
6. A) 3 kilometers per hour.
B) 6 kilometers per hour.
C) 24 kilometers per hour.
D) 180 kilometers per hour.
7. A) Realities of speed and distance.
B) Accidents in the road.
C) Wheel and fender damage.
D) Driving buses in the road.

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

8. A) From some of her friends. C) From a telephone directory.
B) From the wanted column. D) From a television commercial.
9. A) She finished her secondary school.
B) She studied in a vocational college.
C) She graduated from an open university.
D) She received full-time education abroad.
10. A) She teaches an evening class. C) She is a policewoman.
B) She works as a tour guide. D) She is a shorthand-typist.
11. A) A job in a travel agency. C) A job as a policewoman.
B) A job in the government. D) A job as a teacher.

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

12. A) It was interrupted for four years.
B) It has been off and on for ten years.
C) It helps enlarge his customer network.
D) It provides him with career opportunities.
13. A) Traditional setting. C) Social games.
B) Individualized service. D) Home-made beer.
14. A) The quality of beer. C) The atmosphere.
B) The owner's attitude.. D) The right location.
15. A) It makes retirees feel useful. C) It is a profitable business.
B) It helps old people kill time. D) It is a rather tough job.

Section C

Directions: *In this section, you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.*

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.

16. A) It helps the user to escape reality.
B) It is becoming increasingly popular.
C) It hurts a person and those around them.
D) It gives rise to serious social instability.
17. A) They take drugs to get high.
B) They use drugs just for fun.
C) They use drugs as medicine.

- D) They keep drug use a secret.
18. A) It is fatal to the user.
 B) It is hard to get rid of.
 C) It is the cause of various social problems.
 D) It is quite common in entertainment circles.

Questions 19 to 22 are based on the passage you have just heard.

19. A) Taking up exercises after recovery.
 B) Finding new ways to cure heart disease.
 C) Going on a diet upon leaving the hospital.
 D) Producing tasty healthy frozen food.
20. A) It was carefully tested with consumers.
 B) It was disapproved by many diet experts.
 C) It was promoted by health organizations.
 D) It was highly expected by the general public.
21. A) Competitive price.
 B) Vigorous promotion.
 C) Low expectations.
 D) Unique ingredients.
22. A) It has a positive implication for consumers.
 B) It tricks the elders into impulse purchasing.
 C) It matches the food's dark green packaging.
 D) It was suggested by the firm's vice-president.

Questions 23 to 25 are based on the passage you have just heard.

20. A) It will be abolished sooner or later.
 B) It is practiced in most of the states.
 C) It has to be approved by the Supreme Court.
 D) It has drawn a lot of criticism from overseas.
21. A) What effect it might have on youngsters.
 B) What type of criminals should receive it.
 C) Whether there should be a minimum age limit for execution.
 D) Whether the practice should be allowed to continue in future.
25. A) The court sentenced him to life in prison for killing two friends.
 B) The governor changed his death sentence to life in prison.
 C) He was the first minor to be executed in South Carolina.
 D) He was sentenced to death for a crime he committed as a minor.

Part III
Section A

Reading Comprehension

(40 minutes)

Directions: *In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.*

Questions 26 to 35 are based on the following passage.

Children do not think the way adults do. For most of the first year of life, if something is out of sight, it's out of mind. If you cover a baby's 26 toy with a piece of cloth, the baby thinks the toy has disappeared and stops looking for it. A 4-year-old may 27 that a sister has more fruit juice when it is only the shapes of the glasses that differ, not the 28 of juice.

Yet children are smart in their own way. Like good little scientists, children are always testing their child-sized 29 about how things work. When your child throws her spoon on the floor for the sixth time as you try to feed her, and you say, "That's enough! I will not pick up your spoon again!" the child will 30 test your claim. Are you serious? Are you angry? What will happen if she throws the spoon again? She is not doing this to drive you 31; rather, she is learning that her desires and yours can differ, and that sometimes those 32 are important and sometimes they are not.

How and why does children's thinking change? In the 1920s, Swiss psychologist Jean Piaget proposed that children's *cognitive* (认知的) abilities unfold 33, like the blooming of a flower, almost independent of what else is 34 in their lives. Although many of his specific conclusions have been 35 or modified over the years, his ideas inspired thousands of studies by investigators all over the world.

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|----------------|----------------|
| A) advocate | I) immediately |
| B) amount | J) naturally |
| C) confirmed | K) obtaining |
| D) crazy | L) primarily |
| E) definite | M) protest |
| F) differences | N) rejected |
| G) favorite | O) theories |
| H) happening | |

Section B

Directions: *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.*

The Perfect Essay

- A) Looking back on too many years of education, I can identify one truly impossible teacher. She cared about me, and my intellectual life, even when I didn't. Her expectations were high—impossibly so. She was an English teacher. She was also my mother.
- B) When good students turn in an essay, they dream of their instructor returning it to them in exactly the same condition, save for a single word added in the margin of the final page: "Flawless." This dream came true for me one afternoon in the ninth grade.

Of course, I had heard that genius could show itself at an early age, so I was only slightly taken aback that I had achieved perfection at the tender age of 14. Obviously, I did what any professional writer would do; I hurried off to spread the good news. I didn't get very far. The first person I told was my mother.

- C) My mother, who is just shy of five feet tall, is normally incredibly soft-spoken, but on the rare occasion when she got angry, she was terrifying. I am not sure if she was more upset by my *hubris* (得意忘形) or by the fact that my English teacher had let my ego get so out of hand. In any event, my mother and her red pen showed me how deeply flawed a flawless essay could be. At the time, I am sure she thought she was teaching me about mechanics, *transitions* (过渡), structure, style and voice. But what I learned, and what stuck with me through my time teaching writing at Harvard, was a deeper lesson about the nature of creative criticism.
- D) First off, it hurts. Genuine criticism, the type that leaves a lasting mark on you as a writer, also leaves an existential *imprint* (印记) on you as a person. I have heard people say that a writer should never take criticism personally. I say that we should never listen to these people.
- E) Criticism, at its best, is deeply personal, and gets to the heart of why we write the way we do. The intimate nature of genuine criticism implies something about who is able to give it, namely, someone who knows you well enough to show you how your mental life is getting in the way of good writing. Conveniently, they are also the people who care enough to see you through this painful realization. For me it took the form of my first, and I hope only, encounter with writer's block—I was not able to produce anything for three years.
- F) Franz Kafka once said: "Writing is utter *solitude* (独处), the descent into the cold *abyss* (深渊) of oneself." My mother's criticism had shown me that Kafka is right about the cold abyss, and when you make the *introspective* (内省的) descent that writing requires you are not always pleased by what you find. But, in the years that followed, her sustained tutoring suggested that Kafka might be wrong about the solitude. I was lucky enough to find a critic and teacher who was willing to make the journey of writing with me. "It is a thing of no great difficulty," according to Plutarch, "to raise objections against another man's speech, it is a very easy matter; but to produce a better in its place is a work extremely troublesome." I am sure I wrote essays in the later years of high school without my mother's guidance, but I can't recall them. What I remember, however, is how she took up the "extremely troublesome" work of ongoing criticism.
- G) There are two ways to interpret Plutarch when he suggests that a critic should be able to produce "a better in its place." In a straightforward sense, he could mean that a critic must be more talented than the artist she *critiques* (评论). My mother was well covered on this count. But perhaps Plutarch is suggesting something slightly different, something a bit closer to Marcus Cicero's claim that one should "criticize by creation, not by finding fault." Genuine criticism creates a precious opening for an author to

become better on his own terms—a process that is often extremely painful, but also almost always meaningful.

- H) My mother said she would help me with my writing, but first I had to help myself. For each assignment, I was to write the best essay I could. Real criticism is not meant to find obvious mistakes, so if she found any—the type I could have found on my own—I had to start from scratch. From scratch. Once the essay was “flawless,” she would take an evening to walk me through my errors. That was when true criticism, the type that changed me as a person, began.
 - I) She criticized me when I included little-known references and professional *jargon* (行话). She had no patience for brilliant but irrelevant figures of speech. “Writers can’t bluff (虚张声势) their way through ignorance.” That was news to me—I would need to find another way to structure my daily existence.
 - J) She trimmed back my flowery language, drew lines through my exclamation marks and argued for the value of restraint in expression. “John,” she almost whispered. I leaned in to hear her: “I can’t hear you when you shout at me.” So I stopped shouting and bluffing, and slowly my writing improved.
 - K) Somewhere along the way I set aside my hopes of writing that flawless essay. But perhaps I missed something important in my mother’s lessons about creativity and perfection. Perhaps the point of writing the flawless essay was not to give up, but to never willingly finish. Whitman repeatedly reworked “Song of Myself” between 1855 and 1891. repeatedly. We do our absolute best with a piece of writing, and come as close as we can to the ideal. And, for the time being, we settle. In critique, however, we are forced to depart, to give up the perfection we thought we had achieved for the chance of being even a little bit better. This is the lesson I took from my mother: If perfection were possible, it would not be motivating.
- 36. The author was advised against the improper use of figures of speech.
 - 37. The author’s mother taught him a valuable lesson by pointing out lots of flaws in his seemingly perfect essay.
 - 38. A writer should polish his writing repeatedly so as to get closer to perfection.
 - 39. Writers may experience periods of time in their life when they just can’t produce anything.
 - 40. The author was not much surprised when his school teacher marked his essay as “flawless”.
 - 41. Criticizing someone’s speech is said to be easier than coming up with a better one.
 - 42. The author looks upon his mother as his most demanding and caring instructor.
 - 43. The criticism the author received from his mother changed him as a person.
 - 44. The author gradually improved his writing by avoiding fancy language.
 - 45. Constructive criticism gives an author a good start to improve his writing.

Section C

Directions: *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on Answer Sheet 2 with a single line through the centre.*

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

Could you reproduce Silicon Valley elsewhere, or is there something unique about it?

It wouldn't be surprising if it were hard to reproduce in other countries, because you couldn't reproduce it in most of the US either. What does it take to make a Silicon Valley? It's the right people. If you could get the right ten thousand people to move from Silicon Valley to Buffalo, Buffalo would become Silicon Valley.

You only need two kinds of people to create a technology *hub* (中心) : rich people and *nerds* (痴迷科研的人).

Observation bears this out. Within the US, towns have become startup hubs if and only if they have both rich people and nerds. Few startups happen in Miami, for example, because although it's full of rich people, it has few nerds. It's not the kind of place nerds like.

Whereas Pittsburg has the opposite problem: plenty of nerds, but no rich people. The top US Computer Science departments are said to be MIT, Stanford, Berkeley, and Carnegie-Mellon. MIT yielded Route 128. Stanford and Berkeley yielded Silicon Valley. But what did Carnegie-Mellon yield in Pittsburgh? And what happened in Ithaca, home of Cornell University, which is also high on the list?

I grew up in Pittsburgh and went to college at Cornell, so I can answer for both. The weather is terrible, particularly in winter, and there's no interesting old city to make up for it, as there is in Boston. Rich people don't want to live in Pittsburgh or Ithaca. So while there're plenty of *hackers* (电脑迷) who could start startups, there's no one to invest in them.

Do you really need the rich people? Wouldn't it work to have the government invest in the nerds?

No, it would not. Startup investors are a distinct type of rich people. They tend to have a lot of experience themselves in the technology business. This helps them pick the right startups, and means they can supply advice and connections as well as money. And the fact that they have a personal stake in the outcome makes them really pay attention.

46. What do we learn about Silicon Valley from the passage?

- A) Its success is hard to copy anywhere else.
- B) It is the biggest technology hub in the US.
- C) Its fame in high technology is incomparable.
- D) It leads the world in information technology.

47. What makes Miami unfit to produce a Silicon Valley?

- A) Lack of incentive for investments.

- B) Lack of the right kind of talents.
 - C) Lack of government support.
 - D) Lack of famous universities.
48. In what way is Carnegie-Mellon different from Stanford, Berkeley and MIT?
- A) Its location is not as attractive to rich people.
 - B) Its science departments are not nearly as good.
 - C) It does not produce computer hackers and nerds.
 - D) It does not pay much attention to business startups.
49. What does the author imply about Boston?
- A) It has pleasant weather all year round.
 - B) It produces wealth as well as high-tech.
 - C) It is not likely to attract lots of investors and nerds.
 - D) It is an old city with many sites of historical interest.
50. What does the author say about startup investors?
- A) They are especially wise in making investments.
 - B) They have good connections in the government.
 - C) They can do more than providing money.
 - D) They are rich enough to invest in nerds.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

It's nice to have people of like mind around. Agreeable people boost your confidence and allow you to relax and feel comfortable. Unfortunately, that comfort can hinder the very learning that can expand your company and your career.

It's nice to have people agree, but you need conflicting perspectives to dig out the truth. If everyone around you has similar views, your work will suffer from confirmation *bias* (偏颇).

Take a look at your own network. Do your contacts share your point of view on most subjects? If yes, it's time to shake things up. As a leader, it can be challenging to create an environment in which people will freely disagree and argue, but as the saying goes: From confrontation comes brilliance.

It's not easy for most people to actively seek conflict. Many spend their lives trying to avoid arguments. There's no need to go out and find people you hate, but you need to do some self-assessment to determine where you have become stale in your thinking. You may need to start by encouraging your current network to help you identify your blind spots.

Passionate, energetic debate does not require anger and hard feelings to be effective. But it does require moral strength. Once you have worthy opponents, set some ground rules so everyone understands responsibilities and boundaries. The objective of this debating game is not to win but to get to the truth that will allow you to move faster, farther, and better.

Fierce debating can hurt feelings, particularly when strong personalities are involved. Make sure you check in with your opponents so that they are not carrying the emotion of the battles beyond the battlefield. Break the tension with smiles and humor to reinforce the idea that this is friendly discourse and that all are working toward a common goal.

Reward all those involved in the debate sufficiently when the goals are reached. Let your sparring *partners* (拳击陪练) know how much you appreciate their contribution. The more they feel appreciated, the more they'll be willing to get into the ring next time.

51. What happens when you have like-minded people around you all the while?

- A) It will help your company expand more rapidly.
- B) It will create a harmonious working atmosphere.
- C) It may prevent your business and career from advancing.
- D) It may make you feel uncertain about your own decisions.

52. What does the author suggest leaders do?

- A) Avoid arguments with business partners.
- B) Encourage people to disagree and argue.
- C) Build a wide and strong business network.
- D) Seek advice from their worthy competitors.

53. What is the purpose of holding a debate?

- A) To find out the truth about an issue.
- B) To build up people's moral strength.
- C) To remove misunderstandings.
- D) To look for worthy opponents.

54. What advice does the author give to people engaged in a fierce debate?

- A) They listen carefully to their opponents' views.
- B) They show due respect for each other's beliefs.
- C) They present their views clearly and explicitly.
- D) They take care not to hurt each other's feelings.

55. How should we treat our rivals after a successful debate?

- A) Try to make peace with them.
- B) Try to make up the differences.
- C) Invite them to the ring next time.
- D) Acknowledge their contribution.

Part IV

Translation

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on **Answer Sheet 2**.

中国父母往往过于关注孩子的学习，以至于不要他们帮忙做家务。他们对孩子的首要要求就是努力学习，考得好，能上名牌大学，他们相信这是为孩子好。因为在中国这样竞争激烈的社会里，只有成绩好才能保证前途光明。中国父母还认为，如果孩子能在社会上取得大的成就，父母就会受到尊敬。因此，他们愿意牺牲自己的时间、爱好和兴趣，为孩子提供更好的条件。